THAMESMEAD TIMES...

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November 1995

The Front Page

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TWO YEARS TRYING TO SELL ENDS WITH BARRATT HOME EXCHANGE



For Barbara and Tim Pease, the famous Barratt Home Exchange Service ended two years of frustration trying to sell their old London property.

Barratt accepted their former home - a one-bedroom house - at 100 per cent of its independent valuation, clearing the way for them to move into a brand new three-bedroom house overlooking a magnificent lake at 'Lakeside Park' in Thamesmead.

Barbara, 28, a support analyst in the City, said: "Barratt solved our problem by taking our old house in part-exchange, but it was more than that which made us turn to them in the first place.

'We were very attracted to Lakeside Park and the style of the houses there. The development is lovely, on the edge of a lake in marvellous landscaped grounds. People who come down here just can't believe how picturesque it is."

Barbara and 29 year-Tim, a printer, previously lived elsewhere in Thamesmead and, as local people wanted to stay in the area.

"When we saw Lakeside Park and heard about the possibility of part-exchange, we looked into it and found there were no hidden catches. We got the price we were asking for our old house, even though it hadn't sold at that price for two years" said Barbara.

The development is close to the new Thamesmead Central shopping centre and well located for schools, health and leisure facilities. Commuter rail services are available from nearby Abbey Wood and Plumstead BR stations. Blackwall Tunnel and the M25 are within easy driving distance. Barratt also have further developments in the Thamesmead area.

The Peases are Barratt's 200,000th BUYERS!

What the Peases couldn't have known as their purchase of 'Lakeside Park' legally completed was that they were buying the 200,000th new home built by Barratt nationwide.

They soon found out when Barratt staff in London swept them away for a surprise flight in the famous Barratt helicopter and a presentation from Barratt Developments founder and chairman Sir Lawrie Barratt. He presented them with a luxury holiday at a Barratt resort in Spain.

"It was the best possible surprise" said Barbara. "We're both thrilled."

THE GENESIS PROGRAMME

A NEW BEGINNING, A PRESCRIPTION FOR HEALTH, IN FACT THE IDEAL PRESCRIPTION FOR A HEALTHIER, HAPPIER LIFESTYLE.

TALK TO YOUR DOCTOR, NURSE OR PHYSIO

OR PICK UP A LEAFLET FROM THAMESMERE LEISURE CENTRE, THAMESMERE DRIVE, THAMESMEAD SE28.

TELEPHONE: 0181-311 1119

See page 8 for further details

PHOTOGRAPHIC COMPETITION WINNER

Thamesmead are happy to announce the winners of the photographic competition who are:

Mr. F. Woolford, Mr. J. Levett, A. J. Clark, Doreen McLean, Miss M.A. Mark, Mr. I J. Green, Miss A. Perry

The winning entries will be featured in the December issue of the Thamesmead Times.

CONGRATULATIONS TO ALL OUR WINNERS AND MANY THANKS TO EVERYONE WHO ENTERED!

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Dental Centre

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London SE28 0ER
0181 316 6313
New patients now being registered.
NHS and Private.
Kids are special to us.
Home visits for housebound.
Smile . . .
and pass it on!

THAMESBANK INSURANCE SERVICES
9 JOYCE DAWSON WAY THAMESMEAD
FOR THE CHEAPEST MOTOR OR CONTENTS QUOTES RING US NOW ON
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Gregory Lomax commented: "Thamesmead Town is sorry that the proposed move of St. Paul's is not now going to take place. We shall work closely with London Borough of Greenwich to help develop new uses and opportunities for the existing school buildings which are obviously a valuable resource for our community. I am arranging a meeting with London Borough of Greenwich to discuss this issue shortly."

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Councillor Clive Efford, Chair of the Council's Health, Environment and Public Protection Committee said: "The commissioning of this study is a clear example of the Council's commitment to improve Woolwich Markets and the Town Centre generally."

INSPIRING THE RESIDENTS OF THAMESMEAD



Deacon; Producer and Presenter for RTM; wife; mother and grandmother. Wendy Saunders is a Curate in the town of Thamesmead and although she may wear many hats Wendy has got her feet planted firmly on the ground.

In 1990, Wendy was working with the Church in a lay role, and when the Reverend Chris Byers began to look into the setting up of an independent radio station, she volunteered her services to ensure "that it wasn't highjacked by men and the clergy and that there would be a forum for the 'woman's voice'."

When the call went up for a presenter for the 3.30pm recording of the first show on Friday, March 23rd 1990 – Wendy was the only one with a space free in her diary and her career in radio took off.

Over the past five years, Wendy's religious broacasting has earned her and her team several awards and commendations.The first in 1992 when her programme, First Day Cover won an Andrew Cross commendation for an interview by reporter Tony Stayne, who had trained with RTM, with a group of Bangladeshi Sisters who had been coping with the terrible floods in their country.

In 1993, Wendy's coverage of David Diamonds funeral in Deptford acheived an Andrew Cross award – the funeral made the TV news and so did Wendy – she had been joined by the TV man in the aisle!

The Andrew Cross Awards are administered by CACLB (the Churches Advisory Council for Local Broadcasting), they are named in memory of the late Stuart Cross (Church of England Bishop) and the late Agnellus Andrew (Roman Catholic Bishop) in recognition of their contributions to religious broadcasting.

The Sandford St. Martin Trust Award, endowed by a local family of the town of the same name, is presented to TV and Radio broadcasters, both local and national - and in 1994, this prestigious award was presented, in the form of a Merit Award plus £1000 to Wendy who received it on November 16th at Lambeth Palace last year for her programme on the Bromley By Bow Centre.

What was unique about this presentation, was that it was the only award given to an independent radio station, and probably the smallest station at that - all the others were given to the BBC.

One of her most precious awards related to an interview she did with Shadrach Peter whose daughter, Sweetie, was in England for treatment of a rare disease which required a bone marrow transplant, this 12 year old from Bangalore sadly died, in between the interview and the award. Wendy wrote to Mr. Peter describing the award as 'honouring the memory of that brave little girl.'

The Church of England have now ensured that Wendy's job description includes radio broadcasting.

On October 1st 1995, Wendy was ordained a Deacon of the Church of England during, as she put it, "a splendid ceremony" in Southwark Cathedral with "wonderful music", with 16 men and women being ordained that day, the Cathedral was full of family, friends and supporters creating "what can only be described as a very special atmosphere."

October 1996 will see Wendy finally ordained a Priest and although women have been ordained as Deacons since 1987, it was only in 1994 that the Church of England took the historic step of ordaining women as Priests.

These past five years have been very special to Wendy Saunders who has come such a long way from managing as a lone parent and a victim of domestic violence.

Today, Wendy is married to her second husband Norman Smith, and between them they have five children and five grandchildren.

EVENNETT KEEPS UP PRESSURE AGAINST INCINERATOR

David Evennett MP has continued to voice his opposition to the Powergen/Cory proposals for a Waste-to-Energy Incinerator in Belvedere.

Mr Evennett has made his views known to Ministers and has urged another Public Inquiry into the application "to allow local residents a say in a matter which will seriously affect the people of our Borough of Bexley".

In a question to the Energy Minister at the House of Commons, Mr Evennett asked Tim Eggar when he expected to make an announcement on the proposal.

The Minister replied that his officials were seeking further environmental details from Powergen.

Mr Evennett commented: "We need to keep up the pressure on this important issue".

HOUSING GRANTS FOR THE ELDERLY

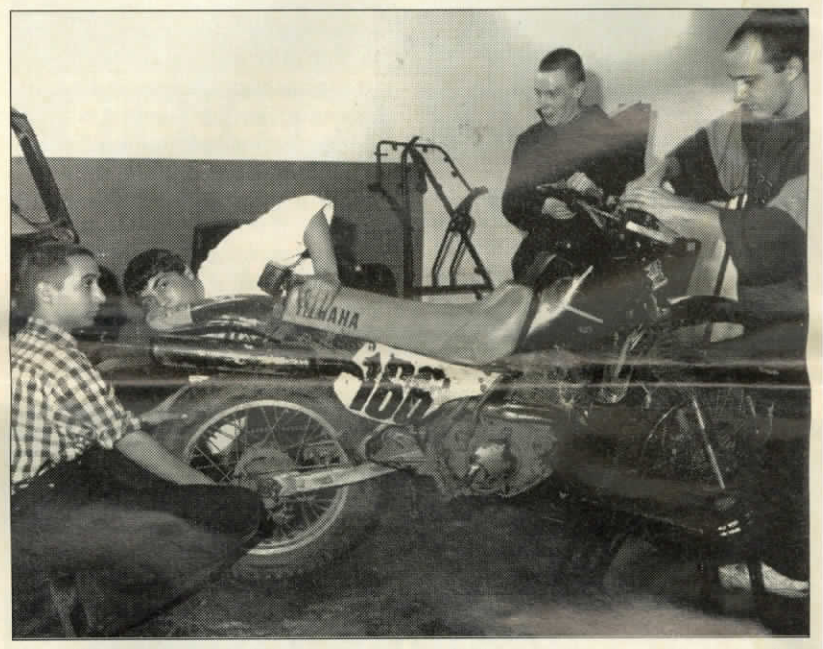
Elderly people in the borough of Greenwich who own their own home or rent private accommodation may qualify for grants up to £1,080 to carry out improvements to their home.

The grants cover: Minor adaptions, eg hand rails, improved kitchen cupboards, work surfaces or hot water systems; Security measures, eg door entry systems, door and window locks; Energy efficiency measures, eg thermal insulation, draughtproofing.

The grants are available to householders in the borough who are; over 60; and in receipt of either Income Support, Housing Benefit, Council Tax Rebate or Family Credit; and own their own home or rent in the private sector or from a housing association

Anyone who thinks they may be eligible should contact Greenwich Council's Housing Aid Centre on 0181 312 5709

Archway project



The Thamesmead Times was invited along to the Archway Project at Thamesmead to find out what it is all about and how it serves the community. I met Simon Pavey, co-ordinator and Dave Newman, development worker. They showed me round and explained the 'Archways background and future hopes'.

It was formed 13 years ago by Social Services, initiated by Mary Chambers of Trust Thamesmead who took a great interest in the project and was there at the start.

The Archway Project is funded in the main by the London Borough's of Bexley and Greenwich, both putting in a third of the monies, the other third is funded by charitable trusts.

It is run by four paid staff and volunteers. They are always on the lookout for more volunteers, if there are any readers who are mechanically minded with some spare time on their hands or perhaps with an interest in the local community and its youth who know nothing about mechanics but could spare two hours every six weeks to sit on the committee their time would be appreciated.

The evening groups are full to capacity, however, the Thursday group for the unemployed from 11am to 2pm is under subscribed. This is an informal group giving training in car/bikes mechanics, teaching people to do general maintenance and service on their own vehicles. They are able to use the project tools and equipment and work in a dry atmosphere under supervision. Women have always benefited greatly from this class, as it teaches them how to maintain and service their own car, thereby saving pounds on garage fees.

Dave said: "The Archway project provides an excellent service to the community by offering an exciting positive and challenging activity for the young people of Thamesmead."

If you would like further information or would like to offer your services, please telephone Dave Newman, The Archway Project, Archway 6, Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead, London SE2. Telephone: 0181-310 1730.

Joint children's network

The Join Children's Network was officially launched on Friday 17th November when local groups who work with disabled children joined Greenwich Social Services in launching the register which will help Greenwich plan services for children and young people with disabilities.

Parents and carers choose whether their child's name is put on the register but already 300 have decided to do so.

The launch of the Network is the result of close discussions and working between Social Services, health, education, voluntary agencies and parents. This multi agency approach means that core information about a child is shared between agencies, with permission from the parents.

Regardless of whether a child with disabilities is placed on the register or not, they can receive a handbook which includes useful information. Information on benefits, schools, the law and national organisations is included and by being computerised and linked to the register means that regular up-dated information can be sent directly to parents and carers.

Anyone interested in receiving more information about the Joint Children's Network should contact The Children with Disabilities Team, 26-28 Powis Street, Woolwich, SE18 6LF or telephone them on 0181-854 8888 ext. 2735.

Grants from Thamesmead Town

Thamesmead Town set aside £10,000 from its annual budget to award grants of up to £3,000 to organisations based in Thamesmead. At its meeting on 8 November 1995, the Board of Thamesmead Town endorsed the recommen-dations of the Grants Committee in awarding grants totalling £6809 to community groups in Thamesmead.

Cheques for these grants will be presented to the successful applicants over the next few weeks and it is hoped that the presentation of some of these cheques will be featured in a future issue of Thamesmead Times. This means that there is a balance of £3191 which has not been spent. It was decided therefore that community groups based in Thamesmead, who had not previously applied for a grant this year should be allowed to apply for small grants up to £250. If you are interested in applying for a grant, please contact the Directors Support Unit on 0181-310 1500 extension 392. All completed applications will need to be received by 5 January 1996 and any money awarded will need to be spent by 1 March 1996.

Whilst on the subject of grants, Thamesmead Town has also made available £2,000 to make awards of up to £150; therefore, even if you are not thinking of a grant at the moment you may wish to keep this in mind for any future activities.

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David Irons Vice Chairman of Thamesmead Town Reports



In my own consitituency meeting, for the Waterfield district, Gregory Lomax, the Chief Executive, outlined the way foward for the future of the Town and its residents. All those who attended appeared to appreciate that things were now on the move in regard to the new developments in our Town which has remained so static over the past few years.

One of the main issues raised by Tenants and Owner Occupiers alike in this area, was that of anti social behaviour of youths. As a member of the Commitee against Anti social behaviour, I am able to confirm that we are able to take on board complaints of this nature to enable ourselves to 'get our act together' in dealing adequately with these problems.

It was a worthwhile and constructive meeting.

I also attended the regatta on the Southmere Lake run by the YMCA and the Royal Yacht Association. George Reynolds and his able helpers made a wonderful day for the youngsters taking part. Thamesmead Town had sponsored the event, and everyone who participated received a medal to commemorate the day. I had the honour to do the presentations which included an etched copper submarine plaque of the Nautilus to the organising body. It was a very enjoyable experience.

At the Company's Annual General Meeting held in Heronsgate School, my elected colleagues showed sufficient faith in me to once again give me the honour of being company Vice Chairman for another year – sadly, at the same meeting, we were given the news that our Chairman, Sir James Mellon, will be leaving us in January 1996.

Assistant Company Secretary, Josephine Morgan joined me in attending the Mayor of Bexley's Charity Ball for a most pleasant evening and a good deal of funds were raised for the deserving charities.

With my colleagues on the Board, I have attended various development sites to see examples of new houses for both renting and purchasing – these type of properties will no doubt be a part of the future of our town.

The Board's biggest job now is to seek a new Chairman to assist us in furthering the success of the Town while working closely with our Chief Executive to develop a better place in which to live and to work.

For us all to be part of Thamesmead's progress into the future for the benefit of everyone, is my sincere hope.

Councillors Surgeries – Bexley

Thamesmead East
Councillors Donna Briant and Ron Brierly
Last Saturday of each month at the Pyramid Club, Tavy Bridge
12 noon-1pm

Thamesmead Town Directors Surgeries

Broadwaters (Area 1)
Ray Hutchins; Broadwaters Village Hall.
2nd Saturday 11 am-12 noon

Waterfield (Area 2)
David Irons; 33 Waterfield Close (Home),
Every Monday evening 7.15 pm-9.15 pm. 0181-311 7761

Moorings (Area 3)
Ian Savill; Jubilee Centre, Lytton Strachey Path.
Alternate Thursday evenings 7pm - 8pm. 23rd Nov, 7th Dec, 21st Dec etc.

Manorway (Area 4)
Gerry Bright; 33 Linnet Close, Thamesmead North (Home).
Telephone: 0181 311 1946

Crossway (Area 5)
Albert Devereux; 7 Longworth Close (Home).
Daily 9am-8pm, Telephone: 0181 244 9323

Southmere (Area 6)
Austin Gavin; Binsey Walk, Patch Office
1st and 3rd Saturday of the month 11am-1pm
Telephone 0181 310 9811

Lesnes (Area 7)
Tina Anderson; Evenlode House Patch Office
1st Saturday of every month 10am-11pm

Parkview (Area 8)
Katharine Galloway; 32 a/b Maran Way,
Telephone 0181 310 9671. 1st and 3rd Saturday 10.30am-12.30pm

Greenmead (Area 9)
David Shanks; Greenmead Clubroom Lime Row,
1st Saturday each month 9am-10am
Telephone: 0181 312 1371 (Before 9.45am)

ARTILLERY HELPS POPPY APPEAL

The newly arrived 16th Regiment of the Royal Artillery helped boost the Poppy Day Appeal in Greenwich this year.

Members of the 32 Minden Battery took a 25 pounder gun dating from World War II into Woolwich, Charlton and Eltham to assist members of the Royal British Legion with their street collection.

The soldiers, in full ceremonial dress were at Beresford Square in Woolwich on 6th and 7th November.

Lt. Gover of the 16th Regiment, Royal Regiment of Artillery said "We are now very much a part of Woolwich and were looking forward to helping to raise funds for the Royal British Legion. We were overwhelmed by the public response when we marched through Woolwich and it is great to be able to give something back to the residents of the Borough.

Councillor Tony Moon, Mayor of Greenwich, went along to Beresford Square to inspect the gun. He said: "The Poppy Day Appeal reminds us of the great sacrifices made during two World Wars and raises funds which enable the Royal British Legion to carry on it's good work, and gives us a chance to show our respect and gratitude."

Thamesmead East Ward – By Election

The Returning Officer has received notice from two electors in the Thamesmead East Ward requiring the vacancy in the ward to be filled. In accordance with the provisions of Section 89 of the Local Government Act 1972 the Returning Officer is required to hold the election within 35 days (excluding Saturdays and Sundays) and has decided that this should be Thursday 7th December 1995.

Notice of the Election was published on Thursday 2nd November 1995 and nominations were to be submitted to the Returning Officer at Bexley Civic Offices between the 3rd November and noon on Friday 10th November 1995.

The last date for applications to vote by post will be noon on Monday 20th November 1995 although in the case of illness this can be extended to noon on Wednesday, 29th November 1995.

Polling will take place between the hours of 8am and 9pm on Thursday 7th December and the counting of the votes will be undertaken at a location within the ward immediately after the close of poll.

WEST END STYLES
Ladies Hair and Beauty Salon
Long, short, straight or curly for that Christmas look you want to book early
SPECIAL OFFER UNTIL END OF DECEMBER
Back and Facial Massage Only £10
Hours: Mon, Tues, and Sat 9am-5pm
Wed 9am-12 noon
Thurs and Fri 9am-7pm
Mon and Tues., Senior Citizens Rate
22 Wilton Road, Abbey Wood, London SE2.
Telephone: 0181-311 3397

FREE CAREERS ADVICE

Good news for unemployed people in South London. Passport to Work, which provides free access to a professional careers adviser, has been so successful that it is now to become the lynchpin of SOLOTEC's services for unemployed people. First launched as a pilot in 1993 by SOLOTEC, (South London Training and Enterprise Council), the initiative, praised by one client as "the best move I could have made", now plays a major role in enabling unemployed people to make a career change.

Through Passport to Work, people who have been unemployed for six months benefit from one or more in-depth career interviews with an experienced professional, skilled in turning aspirations into reality.

And, according to an independent survey, this has resulted in 48 per cent going on to training and education, some at degree level. Six months after their interviews, a further 23 per cent are back in employment in careers ranging from warehousing and retail, through information technology to lecturing.

At present, the service is available to unemployed people in Bexley, Bromley, Croydon and Sutton, but plans are in hand to extend the service to residents in the boroughs of Greenwich and Lewisham. Until then unemployed people in those two boroughs are invited to contact SOLOTEC direct to make special arrangements.

If you have been unemployed for six months or more or are returning to work, you may be entitled to a £70 voucher which will buy you vocational advice under Passport to Work. Ring SOLOTEC Customer Services on 0800 800 222 for details.

Working with Beach



T. E. Beach have recently successfully re-tendered for Thamesmead's Minor Civil Engineering Works contract so the familiar sight of Beach's lorries and workmen around the town will continue to be seen for a further three years.

Beach carry out all manner of projects from sewer work through to repairing or resurfacing footpaths, cycle tracks, roads and footbridges, although there are many other demands that Thamesmead makes of them.

Adoption of roads and footways is an important activity currently. Works to Pier Way and Broadwaters footways have been completed recently, and Copperfield Road is underway at the moment.

Sewer vesting which involves suveying, cleaning and repairing is underway in Broadwaters, Waterfield, Moorings, Manorway and Crossways constituencies and further work will commence shortly in these areas. In all around 10 miles of sewers will be vested.

Once the works are complete the sewers are vested in Thames Water Utilities, and the roads adopted by Bexley or Greenwich. The cost of maintenance is then borne by them rather than by Thamesmead Town.

YOU'VE TRIED THE REST NOW TRY THE BEST
Slimming WORLD
THAMESMEAD CLUBS
TUESDAYS 7.30 p.m.
St Pauls Church,
Bentham Road
0181 303 1828
WEDNESDAYS 7 p.m
Lime Row,
Thamesmead South
0181 310 2559
WE ARE THE LARGEST GROWING SLIMMING CLUB IN YOUR AREA . . .
You can lose up to 2 stone in 10 weeks!
So come along and join us and eat yourself slim!

+ + LAST CHANCE ON PRE-CHRISTMAS SAVINGS + +



SELECT AND SAVE

THEN PAY THE EASY WAY

0% CREDIT AVAILABLE ON SELECTED ITEMS FOR PURCHASES OVER £499.00

SUBJECT TO STATUS WRITTEN QUOTATIONS AVAILABLE ON REQUEST

WE OFFER

FREE FREE-FITTING ON CARPETS
£5.95sq/m. £4.99 sq.yd.
FREE-FITTING ON VINYLS
£8.35sq/m. £6.99 sq.yd.

½ PRICE

DURALAY UNDERLAY
(Emerald rubber)

£1.18 sq/m
99p sq.yd

WHEN ORDERING CARPET £10.75 sq/m £8.99 sq.yd OR OVER (HESSIAN-BACKED CARPETS ONLY)

CLEARANCE LINE REDUCED TO CLEAR

NAIRN VINYLS
£4.77 sq.m/£3.99 sq.yd
(while stocks last)
Example 12'x3mts = £51.87 (supply only)

REDUCED ½ PRICE

ECONOMY CORD 4MTS WIDE
NOW
£3.57 sq.m/£2.99 sq.yd
FOAM-BACKED

PRE-CHRISTMAS OFFERS DO NOT APPLY TO INTEREST FREE CLIENTS

REDUCED

½ PRICE BERBER-CORD
NOW
£4.77 SQ.MT
£3.99 SQ.YD
was £8.36
FOAM OR HESSIAN
4MTS WIDE

REDUCED

HEAVY DUTY TWIST
4MTS WIDE
HESSIAN BACKED
WAS **£14.34 SQ.MT**
NOW **£10.75 SQ.MT**
£8.99 SQ.YD
WITH ½ PRICE DURALAY

REDUCED

CUT & LOOP FOAM OR HESSIAN BACKED
4MTS WIDE REDUCED
FROM £13.14 SQ.MT
NOW
£9.55 SQ.MT
£7.99 SQ.YD

PLUS MANY MORE
AS YOUR LOCAL SHOP WE KNOW MOST OF YOUR SIZE'S
FREE ESTIMATES, FREE DELIVERIES OVER £35.00 (local)
FREE SHOP AT HOME SERVICE
PLEASE ACT QUICKLY TO AVOID DISAPPOINTMENT

Tel: 0181 311 3666

Access VISA

Thamesmead Carpets

Open Mon-Sat 9am to 5.30pm



Age Concern Thamesmead

Fifty two Pensioners left Thamesmead on October 22nd for the Age Concern holiday.

Everyone arrived on time to catch the coach even though the clocks had gone back the night before.

75% of the group had gone on the previous year's holiday and the remainder of the group were looking forward to enjoying what they had heard about the year before's holiday.

The staff as usual were friendly and helpful, and the food was excellent. The entertainment was first class with a cabaret every evening.

Coach trips were well attended, visiting Bognor, Portsmouth, Worthing, Arundel and Chichester.

Age Concern Thamesmead would like to thank Age Concern Bexley for their donation towards the holiday.



HOSPICE CHRISTMAS DRAW

The Greenwich and Bexley Cottage Hospice is once again holding a Christmas Draw and tickets costing 50 pence each are now on sale. There are 10 cash prizes totalling £1,000 with the first being £500.

The Hospice held it's first draw last year and raised over £5,000 for the funds and this year the challenge is on to raise substantially more.

The maximum the Hospice can raise after prize money and ticket printing costs have been deducted is in the region of £18,500.

Therefore our target is £18,500!!! Will you help us achieve this target by buying some tickets. Please contact Jim Bennett at the Hospice on 0181 312 2244 or they can be purchased from the Hospice reception desk at 185 Bostall Hill, Abbey Wood.

Your Hospice has been open since the spring of 1994 and all the money raised after deduction of expenses will help to finance the specialist nursing care that the Hospice provides to the terminally ill residents of the London Boroughs of Greenwich and Bexley, 24 hours a day, every day.

NEW YEAR CHARITY DOG WALK

Everyone knows someone who has a dog and therefore our new year dog walk is the event for everyone.

On Monday January 1st 1996 all dogs and their owners are invited to come to Bostall Heath and take a New Year Walk in aid of their hospice.

The event will be staged on Bostall Heath Playing Field, (opposite the Hospice entrance) from 10am till lpm. The walkers can begin their walk at anytime from 10am as long as they have concluded by lpm and they can walk as far as they wish.

Hot drinks will be available for the walker and refreshing water for the dogs.

The ultimate objective of the event will be to raise funds for the Hospice. We suggest two ways of achieving this. You can either get your dog sponsored for their participation or you can donate a suggested minimum of £5 which equates to £1 for each leg and £1 for the wagging tail! ! !

Last year over 50 dogs came and walked for the hospice and raised over £1,000 for the funds. We therefore hope to start the New Year off on a good footing so don't PAWS for thought, bring 'mans best friend' on New Years Day and help your Hospice.

Registration forms are available from the Hospice reception desk or call 0181 312 2244 for further details.

Acorn Playgroup/Glimpsing Green 1 o'clock club.

On Thursday 2nd November the Acorn Playgroup had a visit from the Plumstead Divisional Schools Unit.

Two police officers went along to talk to the children, who had the opportunity to try on helmets, talk into the radios, and to feel the weight of truncheons. Some of the children took the opportunity to be put in hand-cuffs - and loved it.

The police gave a small talk on their work – helping lost children find their parents. The children then went into the police car, the lights were flashing and even the shy children came out of their shells and showed great interest in the police car.

The children benefitted a lot from this experience and it helps bridge the gap between children and the police.

The police went along again on Thursday 9th November at 2pm to show the children a video.

Business Link London South goes live

Local business received a major boost recently with the news that the DTI and Business Link London have formally approved the ambitious plans to establish a Business Link network in South London. The successful business plan was submitted to the DTI by Business Link London South Ltd, a company limited by guarantee, with a board of directors drawn principally from the private sector. A major partnership initiative, the company has the full support of all key business-support organisations.

The first outlet, launched under the name of Business Link South London Ltd, opens in Croydon, and will build on the success already achieved by the Croydon One-Stop Business Centre – now an official Business Link outlet – which has been operating since last October.

The Croydon outlet was formed with the support of key local partners comprising SOLOTEC, London Borough of Croydon, Croydon and South London Chamber of Commerce and Industry, and Croydon Business Venture. The success of Croydon will be replicated with four further outlets, open by Spring 1996, in Bromley, Sutton, Bexley/ Greenwich and Lewisham.

According to Ram Giddomal, acting chairman of Business Link London South: "Our prime objective is to help local business become more competitive an enjoy long-term sustainabl growth. This, in turn, wi contribute to the wealth creatio and economic base of Sout London. We are delighted ou business has been approved, an all partners are now ready to mov ahead apace and establish Business Link network to meet th needs of businesses throughou our local community."

Business Link London South i part of a London-wide network Business Links, under th umbrella of Business Link Londo thus ensuring all local firms enjo immediate access to a wealth information, advice and guidanc With one point of contact, th confusion over who to contact fo business advice and support, an the duplication of activities, will b swept aside.

TENANTS VOTE ON FUNDING

The ballot is on! Greenwich's 32,000 Council tenants are being given the chance to vote themselves more say over cash that goes to support tenants organisations.

Ballot papers delivered to every Council home this month are asking tenants to vote whether money that currently funds tenants services should be brought under direct democratic tenant control.

Three services to tenants are covered by the ballot:

- The Tenants Resource and Information Centre (~RIC) - based in Woolwich, the centre currently employs two full time staff and offers printing, information and research for tenants;
- Tenant Support Workers - these staff help new tenants' groups become established, provide support services and training for existing groups and work with tenants in Area Forums;
- grants to tenants' associations - the annual budget for grants to tenants' groups is currently £28,500, with individual grants ranging from £150 to £2,000. Grants cover hall hire, childcare, publicity and other costs involved in running a group.

The overall cost of these services works out at 14p per tenant per week. In the event of a majority voting 'yes' in the ballot, the Council will set up a Tenants' Fund equivalent to l5p per tenant - allowing lp for administration of the fund. From April 1996 a representative committee of tenants would control how the money was allocated.

It would not mean an increase in rents, nor would there be any change in how tenants pay their rent.

NEW EVENTS AT THE VALLEY
EVERY FRIDAY IS PARTY NIGHT!

Friday 24th November
Last Friday Comedy Night
First of 'Last Friday' of every month comedy nights.
Malcolm Hardee of 'Up the Creek' comperes.
Tickets £3. Members £2.50

Fridays 1st, 8th and 15th December
Christmas Party
Tickets £3. Members £2.50

Friday 22nd December
'Last Friday Comedy Night'
Acts to be announced
All events:
Doors 7pm with 11pm close.

Tickets and information from The Valley, or on 0181-305 2607

WOODLANDS FARM PROJECT - HELP WANTED FOR RECYCLING CENTRE



A new Trust 'First Step Trust' has been commissioned by Greenwich Council's Social Services Department to develop a work project for people with learning disabilities at Woodlands Farm in Shooters Hill.

In order to do this a working group is essential. The Trust is very keen to see this particular project succeed and would like to get local people involved.

Councillor Clive Efford, Chair of Health, Environment and Public Protection Committee said "Our ultimate aim is to create an environmentally and economically productive recycling centre in which local people can get involved, I am sure that this project will be extremely successful and I am confident that local people will put their weight behind it."

Anyone interested in getting involved with the proposed recycling centre should contact Ronnie Wilson or Paul Frazer – 'First Step Trust' – on 0181 293 3005.

During the first year the project will offer work experience and training in decorating, basic horticulture and gardening.

During the following 12 to 18 months the First Step Trust will work closely with Woodlands Farm Trust, Greenwich Council's Socia Services, Hyde Housing Association and other groups involved in the Social Farm Partnership.

The aim of the partnership is t see the site activities developed within the structure of Greenwich Council's Agenda 21 goals.

The site will provide a community resource where local people can take their unwanted newspapers, aluminum cans, grass cuttings and other green waste for recycling. Income generated from recycling will help to fund salaries for project workers.

From stress to sparkle – with a little help from West End Styles







The '90's is a time when the word 'stress' is being used more often, and as, a single mother of three, a full time job and a home to keep I am no different.

When West End Styles of Abbey Wood invited me into their salon to sample their new beauty treatments I jumped at the chance. To be pampered for a few hours would be marvellous.

I was met by Lynn the salon owner and introduced to Nataly, the new beauty consultant.

After an initial consultation it was agreed that I would benefit most from a face and neck massage, facial and makeover and change of hairstyle. We had to keep my list of pampering to a minimum, as unfortunately I was of course, working.

I was given a coffee and taken through to the beauty area where Nataly made me comfortable.

Skin care routine

We discussed my regular routine for looking after my skin. I have very dry, sensitive skin, my daily routine is very simple, I wash with warm water. clean off my make-up with Nivea cream using tissue, and put makeup on.

Nataly pointed out the benefits of spending just a little extra time on my skin, explaining that it really would only take an extra five minutes or so each day, with perhaps one day a week spending a little more time with a facial scrub and mask etc. She assured me "It's as easy as ONE, TWO, THREE, and now I'll show you just how easy." Then the pampering began.

Step one: She removed my makeup with a light solution of cleansing cream, using a very soft makeup pad, slightly damp. Washed my face with water and cleansing cream which made a light lather. This felt really nice as I am used to washing my face in just water which can make it feel tight, this felt good.

Step two: A refreshing, rehydrating tonique was then put on my face. I was a little hesitant, as in the past whenever I have used a tonic it smarts, but this didn't. Nataly explained that I had probably used a tonic containing alcohol and this particular tonic was alcohol free.

Step three: Was to moisturise my face with a daytime extreme moisture protective complex, again no stinging.

Nataly was right, this didn't take an age and something that could be done quite easily as a matter of routine, and 'I could still be in time for work'.

Face Masque

The next process was to use a face masque, (glad to be behind the screen), I felt her apply a very light film over my face, it felt very cool, Nataly said she would be leaving it on for ten minutes, to shut my eyes and just relax. Although I felt the masque solidify, it did not feel as if it would crack should I laugh, and relax I did. I looked in the mirror at the end of ten minutes and the masque was hardly visible. The masque was washed off, leaving my skin feeling well cleansed.

Finally, for the facial came the skin firming lotion (for those wrinkles). This did somehow seem to tighten the skin around the eyes but it didn't feel uncomfortable. I had enjoyed the facial and my skin did feel different, very soft and no flaky patches, I am sure it looked healthier too.

Nataly had talked me through the facial, carefully explaining all the products she was using, and although they can be purchased I was not put under any pressure to do so.

First class pampering is the only way I can describe the facial massage, it was heaven, I was drifting, and on completion when I got up I just barely found my feet.

That was Nataly's part finished, for the time being anyway, later I was to have a makeover, but meanwhile it was over to Lynn the salon owner.

New Hairstyle

We discussed whether or not I would like a haircut, but this I'd had only a week before, and didn't want to lose any more length, so we agreed just to change the style completely. As my hair is completely straight, and always has been I thought it would be nice to see what a perm would look like but without the permanence if you see what I mean.

Lynn put my hair in perm curlers but without the lotion, and after twenty minutes under the hairdryer she brushed it out to show me how I would look with curly hair. I was extremely thankful to be given the opportunity to have a preview, no~ it was definitely not for me, and Lynn agreed. Back to the drawing board, I thought I would have to undergo another hair wash and start again, but being a professional Lynn said we will make the most of those curls and go for an elegant, sophisticated look that would be suitable for a "special evening". She put my hair up in a back pleat, with soft curls left in the front, although this was something that would not suit the office, I certainly felt elegant, and with that little black number that every women has in her wardrobe, I would have been ready to paint the town red.

Although – hang on – I didn't have any makeup on. Back to Nataly. She chose soft colours and a light makeup base, I did not want to look to madeup, more of a natural look.

I really enjoyed my time at the salon. They have built up a good rapport with their clients, everyone was very chatty and it was rather like a coffee morning, with plenty of laughs.

I would like to thank Lynn, Nataly and everyone else at West End Styles for a great couple of hours.

COMPETITION

If you would like the opportunity to spend a day at West End Styles being totally pampered for **FREE**, or you would like to nominate someone, send a recent photograph together with this coupon, no later than **Friday 1st December** to:

West End Styles,
22 Wilton Road,
Abbey Wood, London SE2

I would like to have a days pampering at West End Styles because
(in no more than 25 words)

.....

.....

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.....

.....

or
I would like to nominate

.....
because
(in no more than 25 words)

.....

.....

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.....

.....

Name.....Miss/Mrs/Ms.....

Address.....

.....Daytime telephone number.....

TURKEY – AFTER CHRISTMAS

Many families are now planning their 1996 summer holidays and Turkey is becoming very popular with the British.

During the last seven years I have visited a number of Turkish Resorts and after many requests make the following mini reports and recommendations.

1. I would strongly recommend that families visit in either May/June or late September 9 when you can expect at least 10 hours of sunshine with temperatures up to 80F - 95F.

2. Be prepared for a culture change because Turkey is the meeting point between Asia and Europe, and the mingling of cultures creates a whole variety of East/West customs and experiences for you to absorb. You can find Ancient Monument, and ruins waiting to be explored, but you will also enjoy glorious coastlines with unspoilt beaches and minaret-topped resort towns set in perfect blue bays.

3. You will be pleasantly surprised at the warm welcome you receive and how honest and friendly the Turkish people are. Shopping is very good value with beautiful leather jackets and coats, gold and silver jewellery, all at a fraction of UK prices.

4. Eating out is also good value, the local cuisine is one of the most varied and delicious you'll find anywhere. You pay between £5- £7 for your evening meal including wine and beer. We ate in May 1995 for as little as £2.00 for a 2 course dinner plus a couple of beers.

5. Resorts are many and varied:

Marmaris: A resort buzzing with vibrant life, but no matter whether you want a get away from it all holiday, or your idea of a good holiday is non-stop shopping and a lively nightlife, this place will suit you down to the ground.

Alanya: is a popular market town and attractive Turkish Resort. Wonderful sandy beaches and a lush and inviting landscape.

A huge selection of bars, restaurants and disco's etc with plenty of watersports in the resort.

Bodrum: A blend of old and new, very popular with younger couples. The night life is ideal for the active, with plenty of clubs and Disco's (including Halikarwas, the most famous in Turkey) with spectacular lazer shows and illuminated fountains.

Kemer: A new modern resort which I have to say is my favourite. Good beaches and parks and lovely marina with it's bars and restaurants catering for every taste.

I found the local people really friendly and love talking about English football teams.

Should you wish to have more information on Turkey, please write to the Editor and I will be pleased to assist you.

Till next month, when I will tell you about Cyprus. Pleasant Holiday Dreams.

Gerry B.

SAUCY NEW CORONATION STREET GREETING CARDS





Some of the saucy lines Coronation Street characters have been given in the first official range of Corrie greetings cards would have the nation in stitches if they ever appeared in an episode of Britain's favourite soap.

The 40 strong range includes cheeky captions that poke fun at our favourite characters.

Avid Street fan Steve Best wrote the captions for London based card publisher Paperlink after spending months searching for the funniest photographs at Granada TV Studios, in Manchester.

He said: "I think there's already a lot of subtle humour in the show but not the sort of up front tongue-in-cheek leg-pulling that's on the cards! For the first time ever Corrie fans will be able to see sides of their favourite characters they've never seen before."

The Coronation Street range retails at £1.15 a card and is available from Clinton Cards Shops and other leading card retailers.

MOTHER GOOSE IS COMING TO WOOLWICH – OH YES SHE IS!

In a traditional panto - the first for many years at Woolwich Public Hall - the tale will be told of a kindly widow and her daughter, a youthful principal boy and a comic companion, a demon, a fairy, a greedy squire, a compassionate king and of course THE MAGIC GOOSE. Wonderful costumes, scenery and effects are the ingredients that combine to make a magical rags to riches story, with all the glitter and fun of family pantomime.

An exciting cast is been brought together under the experience and expertise of a Beaux Belles production and dancers from the Dorothy Marshall Stage School.

Sponsored by Trebor Bassetts Sweets, performances start on 26th December and run until 6th January at 2.30 and 7.30 pm daily. Tickets cost £5.00 for a child, and £8.50 or £6.50 for adults, with a family ticket costing £23.00. (Concessions available). There are also group discounts of 10% for 10 or more tickets. For full details contact The Sales Unit on 0181 317 8687 or call in at 151 Powis Street, Woolwich SE18.

NEW INVESTIGATION GROUP FORMED

A Research and Investigation team has been formed locally, to investigate UFO sightings and instances of unexplained phenomena.

The Eltham Supernatural Phenomena Research and Investigation Team (ESPRIT) was set un in November 1994 and has been researching into unexplained occurrences since March this year.

To date, the group has investigated seven reports of UFO sightings in this area alone. Their investigation of one particular sighting received praise from the Director of Quest International, one of the country's biggest UFO organisations

The team now feel able to investigate reports from residents of the local area (Eltham, Kidbrooke, Mottingham, Greenwich, Woolwich, Welling, Lewisham and Peckham) and are willing to investigate any UFO sighting, past or present, and any other instances of unexplained phenomena.

If anyone has witnessed such an occurrence and would like to report it, they can do so by ringing ESPRIT on 0181 850 8964, giving details of the ocurrence. Each case will be dealt with in the strictest confidence.

Relax and de-stress with Thamesmere Leisure Centre

Thamesmere Leisure Centre are now able to offer 6 new opportunities to relax or exercise: courses developed to suit every individual.

From Aqua fit, through Step and Shape, Step to Slim, a Tri Class and the popular Aerobic classes – the new session to capture our imagination is Relaxercise!

Relaxercise is designed for everybody – a method of clearing the mind, fine tuning the body and de-stressing your life. There's no bouncing around, just stretching and gentle movements, "I felt really good after the class" said Stephen Winfield, busy Manager of Thamesmere Leisure Centre.

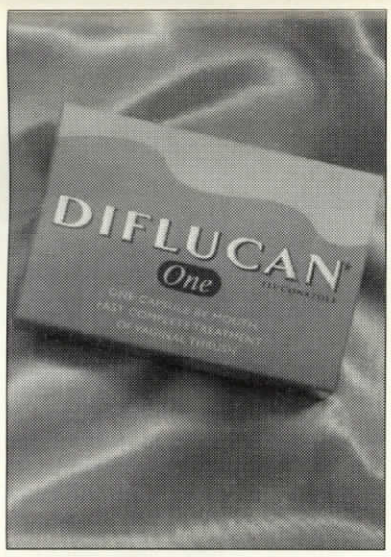
Sue Allen, the instructor is really committed to Relaxercise "It's a way of getting your body to speak to you – and for you to learn to listen to what your body has to say."

Relaxercise fits in perfectly with the ethos of Genesis.

If you are already getting wound up about Christmas – we suggest a few sessions of Relaxercise to keep you cool, calm and collected.

Telephone Thamesmere Leisure Centre for more details on 0181 311 1119.

One-capsule breakthrough for Thrush Sufferers now available over the counter



Vaginal thrush leaves millions of women each year feeling depressed, dirty and degraded, not only because of the extreme discomfort of the condition but also because of the lack of dignity they feel when treating themselves. For those who have had enough of waiting until the bedroom door is closed at night to apply creams or pessaries, an oral treatment is now available to help take the trauma out of treating thrush.

Diflucan One, is a single capsule which is taken by mouth, for fast, complete relief of vaginal thrush. The ingredient in Diflucan One, fluconazole, has been prescribed by doctors and used successfully by thousands of women in the the UK since 1988. Now this oral treatment is available from pharmacists.

"Diflucan One will revolutionise the lives of busy women who suffer from acute or recurrent thrush," says Malcolm Phillips, marketing director of Pfizer Consumer Healthcare, which produces Diflucan One.

"As a single oral capsule, Diflucan One is far more convenient than conventional topical treatments such as creams and pessaries. The single capsule can be taken immediately, with or without food, as soon as the symptoms of thrush are recognised, and starts working after two hours. Symptoms are usually relieved after 24 hours and complete relief is obtained after two days."

The Thrush Advice Bureau, a new information service launched by Diflucan One for women concerned about vaginal thrush has been set up with a telephone helpline, giving advice on what thrush is, symptoms, possible causes and treatments. In addition, the Thrush Advice Bureau has published a 16 page A5 booklet entitled 'One to One - a Guide to Understanding Thrush', written by Dr. Angela Robinson, a leading consultant in genito-urinary medicine. The booklet includes detailed information on the causes of thrush and includes tips on preventing thrush and self help advice during an attack of thrush.

A number of factsheets are also available addressing specific issues relating to the condition and its treatment.

Callers with specific concerns not answered by the prepared material are able to write to the Thrush Advice Bureau for a personal response.

The Thrush Advice Bureau can be contacted on: 0171 285 5520. 'One to One - A Guide to Understanding Thrush' is available free by sending a SAE to: The Thrush Advice Bureau, PO Box 8762, London SW7 4ZD.

GENESIS - UPDATE

GENESIS has a new lease of life with the arrival of Ronan Carey the new Genesis Project Officer.

The Genesis Project has been bringing better health to Thamesmead residents since starting in early 1994. Now Ronan, a qualified nurse with experience in coronary and cardiac care, who is also a fitness and gymnastics instructor has reviewed and improved this innovative programme.

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- Arranging educational talks during the evenings – the first on 21st November entitled "Looking after your heart".
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Clients have included heart patients, people with mental affective disorders, those with weight problems, post natal women and those suffering anxiety and stress, people with back problems and others who have been receiving treatment from physiotherapists.

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The report, called "When the Bright Lights Go Out", tells of the experience of around one hundred young people from Scotland who found themselves homeless in London in the winter of 1994-95. It compares their experience to that recounted in a similar study in 1990.

The research shows that despite deep economic recession in London, young Scots are still attracted to London because of the opportunities for work. The report links this to the high level of unemployment and low wages for young people in Scotland. A new feature, however, is that almost a third of the young people in this latest study came to London looking for somewhere to stay. Shelter claim that this is a glaring indictment of housing provision for young people in Scotland.

The report also shows of those interviewed:

- Half of young homeless Scots in London have been in local authority care as children.
- The majority arrived in London penniless or with very little money.
- Over half the young people interviewed had slept rough in London.
- Two thirds would like to return to Scotland at some time.

Kate Caskie, Deputy Director of Shelter Scotland says:

"This is a powerful report which demands action. How much longer must the fruitless trek south continue before action is taken here in Scotland to help these young people? We hear a lot about exports form the Scottish economy. The report reveals the most shameful export: that of disadvantaged young Scots onto the streets of London. The bright lights really do go out for some young Scots in London."

Ms Caskie continued:

"We need to make things better on the streets of London and tackle the problems which cause young people to move away from Scotland. Key workers could help with applying for deposits for private landlords or help make use of furniture initiatives to make it easier for young Scots to stay in Scotland. And if they do move to London, there is a need for short term assistance with cash, for food and clothing for example."

Dennnys Campbell, Director of Borderline says:

"We are concerned by the amount of care leavers making their way to London. There has to be a comprehensive advice and information package targeted at this vulnerable group to make them aware of the realities of living in London and adequately prepare then for any such move. The Returning Home Initiative (RHI) must be revitalised and extended when Scotland's local authorities become unitary. Despite the fact that we have increased our bed provision in London we are struggling to meet the current demand of homeless Scots due to the general shortfall of appropriate accommodation."

DUCHESS LAUNCHES ONE NUMBER FOR THE SAMARITANS

0345 90 90 90

On Thursday 2nd november, The Samaritans launched a new 'one number', which is to run parallel with all existing local branch telephone lines to The Samaritans in the UK. the launch, which took place at St. Stephen's Church, Walbrook, where the charity was founded 42 years ago was attended by HRH The Duchess of Kent, Royal Patron of the charity, and herself a former Samaritan volunteer, and Reverend Chad Varah, Founder of the Samaritans.

Simon Armson, Chief Executive of The Samaritans, said: "We are delighted that the Duchess of Kent has launched 0345 90 90 90. It is probably the most significant development that The Samaritans has known since we were founded 42 years ago. More people will be able to reach us, and to reach the emotional support that is so badly needed."

THE SAMARITANS
0345 90 90 90

ARE YOU FIT - THAT'S THE QUESTION

Are you fit?

Do the mass of keep fit classes put you off of regular exercise?

Are you unsure of where to start?

If any of these questions apply to you or if you are a complete beginner then the Waterfront Leisure Centre has 2 classes that are ideal for you.

No Bodies Perfect (Mondays 6.45pm) and Light Pace Aerobics (Sundays 10.00 am) are ideal starting points for any would be 'Keep Fitters". If you are trying hard to tone up but never quite succeed then the dietary and nutritional advice given out in the classes will be a great help.

AEROBICS AND KEEP-FIT SESSIONS HELD LOCALLY

Tuesday 7pm to 8pm

St Michaels Church Hall, Abbey Road

Wednesdays 7pm to 8pm

The Village Hall, Goosander Way, West Thamesmead

Thursdays 7.30pm-8.30pm

the Church of the Cross Hall Lensbury Way, Thamesmead.

All sessions £2.50 by qualified RSA instructor

All levels of fitness welcomed.

For further information telephone:

FIONA MAIRS
0181-312 0993

THAMESMEAD COMPANIES GROW AND GROW

PLASTICS

To accommodate the expansion of its product assembly department in order to help meet the growing demand for its products, Hunter Plastics Ltd has taken over a 30,000 sq ft factory that adjoins its Nathan Way site. The move follows the recent acquisition of another 60,000 sq ft site for development into a new distribution hub for the company's products. The developments represent a significant increase in the size of Hunter's operations as it continues to invest in the Thamesmead area. The company has spent more than £4m in the four years since it became part of Etex, the French-owned group which is the world's largest producer of injection-moulded building products.

Major employer

Already one of Thamesmead's largest employers, Hunter also reports that it has drawn from the local catchment area to expand its workforce by five per cent this year, taking on and training 10 new employees in various parts of its production processes.

"We have continued to develop the business profitably, despite the building market still being in the doldrums," commented Hunter's Managing Director, Chris Nunn. "The availability of suitable labour and factory facilities have been important factors in giving us the confidence to invest in Thamesmead and move ahead."

Thirty years

Hunter Plastics has been 'moving ahead' in Thamesmead since it first arrived at Nathan Way from Belvedere some thirty years ago. As well as establishing a highly successful business now part of a $2 billion international group of companies that employs 23,000 people in over thirty countries – Hunter has long played an active role as part of the Thamesmead business and social community.

Abbey Wood school

The company has close links with local educational establishments, recently donating to Abbey Wood school a robotic teaching centre which allows the children to program a computer system that guides a robot to do different tasks such as using building blocks. "We wanted to give something that would interest and excite the kids about making things happen with computers and machinery," said Chris Nunn. "After all, some of them may be our future recruits!"

Support schemes

The link between education and business is also realised through Chris' involvement as a director of SOLOTEC, which helps local businesses through a wide range of support schemes including structured NVQ training programmes for people employed in the area.

"Hunter is also an active member of the West Thamesmead Business Park Association, of which I am currently the Chairman," said Chris. "Co-operating closely with the local authority and Thamesmead Town, the association managed to get grant funding to improve the whole Business Park environment quite significantly, particularly over the last couple of years. Many people have commented how much they welcome the brighter, tidier look of the area, and we intend to continue with this programme."

The workforce

The people who work at Hunter – the vast majority of them from the Thamesmead area – can see how fast the company is growing. In fact – last Christmas and the one to come – they are reminded of just how fast, as they celebrate their success at the company Christmas dinner dance, held at Brand's Hatch!



PRINTING



The Moger brothers of well known Thamesmead printing firm Richard Edward Limited, made the 'Nationals' back in July 1990 with news of a vast expansion programme.

In the Daily Telegraph article John Moger also stated "we are not making anything at the moment, we are just hoping to survive" despite turnover running at £3 million, profits had been wiped out with the purchase of two large printing presses plus the effects of the recession.

Speculate to accumulate

The Thamesmead Times visited John and Dave Moger to find out more about the company and how things have been progressing over the last five years.

We are happy to report that they have not only survived but have turned business around. The printing machinery that they purchased in 1990 allowed them to 'speculate to accumulate'. which enabled them to bid for larger print jobs and gain new clients. Their client list now includes: Government departments, Building Societies, Publishing Companies, Agencies as well as an extensive list of smaller companies.

New 6 colour press

The good news for 1995 is that they have just purchased a second hand (John Roland) 605 6 colour BI press with an inline UV coater. John made a visit to Ireland to view the machine and then arrangements were made to have it shipped back to England, it was then transported to the factory, stripped down and men have been working constantly, cleaning and servicing all the parts in order to be fully operational by mid November.

John and David made the decision to purchase another 6 colour press as their client list and orders were continuing to increase and it was necessary to have the added reliability of a second machine. They can print anything and everything, brochures, leaflets, Report and Accounts, plus Games cards which are very big business in the '90s.

A tour around the factory and offices was an eye opener, I was surprised at the size of the machinery there, as well as the large printing presses there are machines for cutting, folding, photographing, duplicating and for making plates so the area needed to house these machines was vast.

Staying focussed

David and John have certainly come a long way John from working at home in the family garage!

John said "it is important to stay focused, when the work comes in you keep your head down and get on with it, the printing trade is a very competitive business and we are extremely lucky to have survived the current recession, lots of printing firms have gone under. I would not like to think that I could ever take our situation for granted but we have managed to retain our customers and gain new ones along the way – reliability and service, at affordable prices help us maintain our standing and the new press will give us greater opportunity to expand." So what does the future hold for Richard Edward Limited, John? "I would like to say that we are confidently optimistic."

TRANSPORT

You can't have missed the bright red livery of the EUROPA vehicles which are part of the Thamesmead scene, but do you know much about them? The Thamesmead times went to find out.

EUROPA is a major player in the distribution arena. Europa Freight Corporation, which is the holding company for the Europa Group, has been building a worldwide network since the early '70s, when it was established by founder and Chairman, Andrew Dare. Although originally based in the East End, Thamesmead is now both Head Office and certainly the largest EUROPA depot in the network.

With branches situated in all the major capitals of Europe including Paris, Milan and Amsterdam, EUROPA has a good reputation in the fashion industry for high quality distribution throughout the continent.

Pick and Pack

The rapidly expanding logistics side of the business handles computers, electronics, footwear, toys and games. EUROPA are able to provide what they call in the trade a "pick and pack" service, whereby they are able to warehouse and then on request will pick, pack, label and sort. They provide all risks insurance cover, computerised inventory control, CCTV monitoring and national next day distribution all at competitive rates.

The Europa Group boasts 10 companies in 9 countries, with agents and representatives all over the world. Throughout Europe, the EUROPA team is made up of approximately 1300 employees in at least 56 branches.



Europa and Thamesmead

EUROPA has now been in Thamesmead for more than 16 years and has expanded considerably over this period, so that it now directly and indirectly employs 400 people locally with a further 400 throughout the UK.

During this period, the company has had an excellent relationship with the London Borough of Bexley and the people of Thamesmead and is committed to growing its business in this area, which must be good news for the local population.

Community involvement

EUROPA's Personnel Director, Roland Rampat, believes that because of the company's caring attitude to all of its employees, it has enjoyed excellent staff relations and goodwill from its workforce, which has been an important factor in its success.

EUROPA believes in being actively involved in the Thamesmead community. Throughout the year it supports a variety of local and national charities through funds raised from the annual Charity Fun Day. The 1995 Fun Day raised in excess of £17,000.

Greenmead Football Club benefit from EUROPA sponsorship. Over the years of the their association, sponsorship of the club has taken the form of the provision of training equipment and full kits for both U10 and U13 squads, together with trophies for the winners of an annual 6-a-side tournament.

EUROPA are also involved locally with the Thamesmead Disabled and Senior citizens Centre, sponsoring their day trip to Hastings earlier this year. Already covering most of the world, including Australia, USA, the Far East and Middle East, they are continually expanding the network and are currently in the process of setting up agreements with Vietnam and China.

EUROPA aim to provide a network of distribution by sea and air over the entire world. Another Thamesmead success.

NEW INVESTIGATION GROUP FORMED

A Research and Investigation team has been formed locally, to investigate UFO sightings and instances of unexplained phenomena.

The Eltham Supernatural Phenomena Research and Investigation Team (ESPRIT) was set un in November 1994 and has been researching into unexplained occurrences since March this year.

To date, the group has investigated seven reports of UFO sightings in this area alone. Their investigation of one particular sighting received praise from the Director of Quest International, one of the country's biggest UFO organisations

The team now feel able to investigate reports from residents of the local area (Eltham, Kidbrooke, Mottingham, Greenwich, Woolwich, Welling, Lewisham and Peckham) and are willing to investigate any UFO sighting, past or present, and any other instances of unexplained phenomena.

If anyone has witnessed such an occurrence and would like to report it, they can do so by ringing ESPRIT on 0181 850 8964, giving details of the ocurrence. Each case will be dealt with in the strictest confidence.

Relax and de-stress with Thamesmere Leisure Centre

Thamesmere Leisure Centre are now able to offer 6 new opportunities to relax or exercise: courses developed to suit every individual.

From Aqua fit, through Step and Shape, Step to Slim, a Tri Class and the popular Aerobic classes – the new session to capture our imagination is Relaxercise!

Relaxercise is designed for everybody – a method of clearing the mind, fine tuning the body and de-stressing your life. There's no bouncing around, just stretching and gentle movements, "I felt really good after the class" said Stephen Winfield, busy Manager of Thamesmere Leisure Centre.

Sue Allen, the instructor is really committed to Relaxercise "It's a way of getting your body to speak to you – and for you to learn to listen to what your body has to say."

Relaxercise fits in perfectly with the ethos of Genesis.

If you are already getting wound up about Christmas – we suggest a few sessions of Relaxercise to keep you cool, calm and collected.

Telephone Thamesmere Leisure Centre for more details on 0181 311 1119.

One-capsule breakthrough for Thrush Sufferers now available over the counter



Vaginal thrush leaves millions of women each year feeling depressed, dirty and degraded, not only because of the extreme discomfort of the condition but also because of the lack of dignity they feel when treating themselves. For those who have had enough of waiting until the bedroom door is closed at night to apply creams or pessaries, an oral treatment is now available to help take the trauma out of treating thrush.

Diflucan One, is a single capsule which is taken by mouth, for fast, complete relief of vaginal thrush. The ingredient in Diflucan One, fluconazole, has been prescribed by doctors and used successfully by thousands of women in the the UK since 1988. Now this oral treatment is available from pharmacists.

"Diflucan One will revolutionise the lives of busy women who suffer from acute or recurrent thrush," says Malcolm Phillips, marketing director of Pfizer Consumer Healthcare, which produces Diflucan One.

"As a single oral capsule, Diflucan One is far more convenient than conventional topical treatments such as creams and pessaries. The single capsule can be taken immediately, with or without food, as soon as the symptoms of thrush are recognised, and starts working after two hours. Symptoms are usually relieved after 24 hours and complete relief is obtained after two days."

The Thrush Advice Bureau, a new information service launched by Diflucan One for women concerned about vaginal thrush has been set up with a telephone helpline, giving advice on what thrush is, symptoms, possible causes and treatments. In addition, the Thrush Advice Bureau has published a 16 page A5 booklet entitled 'One to One - a Guide to Understanding Thrush', written by Dr. Angela Robinson, a leading consultant in genito-urinary medicine. The booklet includes detailed information on the causes of thrush and includes tips on preventing thrush and self help advice during an attack of thrush.

A number of factsheets are also available addressing specific issues relating to the condition and its treatment.

Callers with specific concerns not answered by the prepared material are able to write to the Thrush Advice Bureau for a personal response.

The Thrush Advice Bureau can be contacted on: 0171 285 5520. 'One to One - A Guide to Understanding Thrush' is available free by sending a SAE to: The Thrush Advice Bureau, PO Box 8762, London SW7 4ZD.

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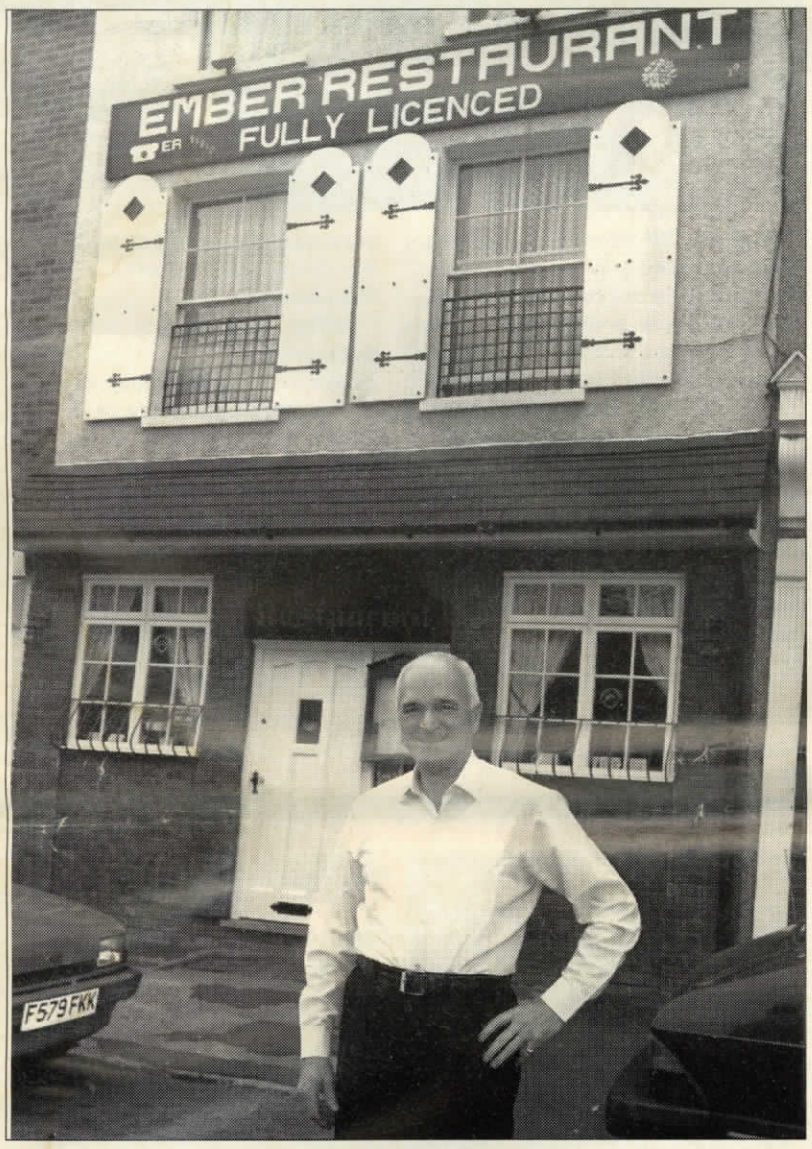
IT'S TV JIM, BUT NOT AS WE KNOW IT

Cable TV subscribers to Videotron, the local cable communications provider, can now venture beyond the outer limits of television with the launch in the UK of The Sci-Fi Channel. From the 1st November 1995, the Sci-Fi Channel will be bringing the most diverse mix of science-fiction, science-fact, fantasy and classic horror entertainment to Videotron cable TV subscribers in its London franchise areas.

The Sci-Fi Channel will be broadcast 24 hours a day, offering viewers a programming line-up similar to its extremely popular counterpart in the United States. This includes box-office and cult films such as: Star Trek II – The Wrath of Khan, Alien and Planet of the Apes; classic series such as Outer Limits, Friday the 13th and Lost in Space, which take viewers into uncharted territory. SciFi-Buzz gives behind the scenes scoops on events within the science fiction culture.

Benjamin Ball, Director of Programming at Videotron, commented: "Sci-Fi is very popular and we're delighted to be able to bring to our customers, at warp speed, the exciting and varied programming that The Sci-Fi Channel will offer."

EMBER - FOR SPANISH HOSPITALITY



A varied menu, fresh food and friendly service in a spanish style environment – that's Ember Restaurant.

Jose Gonzales and his wife Ida have been in Belvedere for 15 years now with their chef, Peter Ferguson, better known as 'Big Hombre', although Jose and Peter have been working together now for at least 20 years.

Committed to the local area, Jose admits a great rapport with his Thamesmead customers who he says "support us, not only at Christmas, but all year round."

Ember's believe in fresh food with a personal touch from "good old English" to rather more exotic dishes such as Crepe Suzette which is Jose's speciality.

There is a set menu for the business lunch, and a Sunday traditional set menu at £10.95, plus of course the A la Carte.

A month after their holiday break, Jose and Ida are already making preparations for the Christmas celebrations.

Christmas lunches will be served up until Christmas Eve.

Last year Ember decided to open on Christmas Day and it was such a success ending up in three sittings that they have decided to open this Christmas Day too and with the second sitting already booked, it's worthwhile calling now if you feel like treating yourself and forgetting the washing up!

Take a look at what you can expect for yourself or maybe the office party:

For Starters:
Soup of the day
Pate Maison
Chilled Melon
Egg Mayonnaise
Prawn Cocktail
or Fruit Juices

Followed by:
Roast turkey
with chestnut stuffing
& Chipolata Sausage
or
Steak Chasseur
or
Gammon Steak with Pineapple
or
Chicken Juliette
or
Fried Fillet of Plaice

Served with:
Roast or Saute Potatoes
and Fresh Vegetables

Dessert:
Mince Pie with Ice Cream
Peach Melba
Black Forest Gateau
Ice Cream
Coffee

This menu is available until Christmas Eve at £13.95.

Telephone Jose and Ida to book your table on: 01322 433810

rtm RADIO 103·8 FM

MONDAY - THURSDAY
06.00 RODNEY COLLINS
07.00 JON LUCAS
11.00 DELROY HAYNES
15.00 RAY BRADSHAW
19.00 SAMMY BELL

FRIDAY
06.00 RODNEY COLLINS
07.00 JON LUCAS
11.00 DELROY HAYNES
14.30 RODNEY COLLINS
15.00 RAY BRADSHAW
19.00 KEN MURRAY

SATURDAYS
07.00 KEN MURRAY
10.00 RICHARD WRIGHT
14.00 RTM SPORTS
18.00 PETER HAYNES
21.00 JON LUCAS (DAT)
22.00 CLIVE R
01.00 STAR SOUND
03.00 THRU THE NIGHT

SUNDAYS
05.00 EDDY BROWN
07.00 RODNEY COLLINS (DAT)
09.00 JON LUCAS
13.00 DELROY HAINES
16.00 SAMMY BELL
18.00 JON LUCAS*
19.00 BEAUTIFUL GAME
21.00 ALBUM CHART – RICHARD WRIGHT (DAT)
21.30 JOHN KENNEDY
00.00 CLUB SHOW
01.00 AYO BADEJO
03.00 THRU THE NIGHT*
*PRE-RECORDED

EVENINGS ON RTM

MONDAYS
21.00 GRUMPY BROWN
00.00 STAR SOUND (BHANGRA SHOW)
03.00 SUPERGOLD

TUESDAYS
21.00 TONY ANDERSON
22.00 KEN MURRAY
00.30 STAR SOUND
03.00 SUPERGOLD

WEDNESDAYS
21.00 SAMMY BELL (FOLK)
22.00 TONY MONSON
00.30 STARSOUND
03.00 SUPERGOLD

THURSDAYS
21.00 WORD ON THE STREET
22.00 KEN MURRAY
00.30 STARSOUND
03.00 SUPERGOLD

FRIDAYS
20.00 RICHARD WRIGHT
22.30 BRIAN ERINGA
00.00 THE GOSPEL SHOW
01.00 STARSOUND
03.00 THRU THE NIGHT

Rodney Collins' Friday Afternoon Interviews

November 24th
Howard Rose, Editor of Radio Magazine 'Expansion of the Radio Industry

December 1st
John Holman, Editor of the Songwriters Magazine, John is a local man!

Your stars for November
by Charity Hope

SCORPIO–*October 24 - November 22*
Your life has resembled a children's see-saw this month, with your relationships up and down, it appears that one side is pretty weighted if this is to improve you must try to balance things, compromise could be your answer.
Good day: 23rd

SAGITTARIUS–*November 23 - December 21*
This is going to be another good month for you, spend spend, spend, might be a little dramatic but whilst you have a few extra pennies why not treat yourself.
Good day: 7th

CAPRICORN–*December 22 - January 20*
A very busy month socially, and at work. Plan your time carefully, and you will be able to enjoy the best of both worlds.
Good day 1st

AQUARIUS–*January 21 - February 19*
Just as money matters are improving along comes Christmas, but don't let your judgement be clouded, make a list and stick to it. Finances are improving but you must keep a tight grip on things.
Good day: 12th

PISCES–*February 20 - March 20*
You may be feeling down in the dumps, this won't last long, there is something just around the corner waiting to cheer you up.
Good day 30th.

ARIES–*March 21 - April 20*
The saying 'Everything's coming up roses' was meant for you this month, a complete turn around of events means that you are in for some real good luck. Lucky you.
Good day: 28th

TAURUS–*April 21 - May 21*
With the festive season almost upon us your work is going to be cut out, so make sure that you look after your health, take those extra vitamins and a rest as and when you can get it.
Good day: 13th

GEMINI–*May 22 - June 22*
There are lots of new faces for you to familiarise yourself with at the moment, and with Christmas on the way your social scene is looking very interesting.
Good day: 22nd

CANCER–*June 23 - July 23*
Don't let this month be all work and no play. Family can come first but they do not need to be first and last and everything, you do deserve to take some time for yourself.
Good day: 4th

LEO–*July 24 - August 23*
This month will be a good month for you and family relationships are much improved. Now is the time to look ahead and make those plans you have been holding back with.
Good day: 8th

VIRGO–*August 24 - September 23*
The domestic side of your life will take front line this month, there have been many changes and now that they have been sorted you have the tidying up to do. You can feel proud of what you have achieved.
Good day: 21st

LIBRA–*September 24 - October 23*
You may have had a disappointment over plans for the Christmas period, but once you understand there was a valid reason you will find that Christmas is one big party.
Good day: 23rd

Carol Services

Bexley Civic Carol Services will take place on the following dates:

- Saturday 9th December at 2.30pm in St. Martin's Church, Barnehurst
- Sunday 11th December at 4pm in St. John's Church, Sidcup
- Wednesday 13th December at 8pm in Crayford Baptist Church, Crayford
- Sunday 24th December at 11.30pm in St. Mary the Virgin, Welling

COUNCILLORS' ANGER AT THREAT TO RAIL SERVICES

Greenwich councillors have expressed dismay at threatened cuts to off-peak train services in the borough under rail privatisation. They also slammed 'inadequate' consultation by the body set up by the Government to oversee selling off the rail network.

Last night's meeting of the Council's Policy and Resources Committee heard warnings that minimum services proposed by Office Rail Franchising (OPRAF) are considerably worse than those currently operating between stations in the borough and central London. A report from Council transportation officers spelled out implications of the proposed service levels including:

- fewer off peak services to stations in the borough;
- services beginning later in the mornings and closing down earlier at night;
- fewer connections and through-services.

Councillors also criticised the consultation – described in the report as 'hasty' and inadequate' – carried out by OPRAF, the body set up by the Government to oversee the sell-off of the rail network.

They agreed to submit a coordinated response to OPRAF's proposals for urgent distribution to train passengers.

'This body has the power to dictate what the minimum level of service should be under a privatised rail network,' said Council Leader Len Duvall. 'The decisions they make will have tremendous impact on the daily lives of Greenwich residents – especially people who commute into London – yet they have refused to carry out direct consultation with the public.

'Even local councils have been given just eight weeks to respond – which doesn't inspire confidence that they really want to hear what we have to say.

He continued, 'South East London commuters already receive a much less frequent service than people in areas served by the tube – where off-peak frequencies of 10,12 or even 14 trains per hour are scheduled.

The level of service outlined by OPRAF would be even poorer than the train service which Greenwich travellers have to put up with now. These proposals would cause inconvenience to thousands of people and drive many commuters back onto the roads, at a time when concern over pollution is on the increase.'

CARE AND SUPPORT FOR PRISONERS WITH HIV/AIDS



£4,000 raised by Councillor Annette Barratt during her year as Mayor was last week handed over to Belmarsh Prison to improve care and support for prisoners with HIV/AIDS.

The bulk of the money will be used for the education of prison officers who wish to run a care and support course for those with the virus and for training equipmcnt. Thcrc will also be a small fund set up for the purchase of small items of clothing for people living with the virus.

Councillor Barratt commented, "I know that Belmarsh Prison is innovative in its approach to prisoners who have the virus and am pleased that funds from my appeal can help their work to go even further. I wish them every success with their work as education and prevention have been proven methods of halting the progress of the infection rate.

The generous response to my appeal for people with HIV/AIDS proved the residents of our Borough care."

Barbara Windsor stars in Dartford's traditional pantomime CINDERELLA

The Orchard, Dartford has announced this year's traditional pantomime, Cinderella which will run from 14th December 1995 until 20th January starring Barbara Windsor as the Fairy Godmother.

This will be a welcome return for Barbara who starred in The Orchard's Christmas production of Dick Whittington in 1984. Famous for her role in many of the Carry On Films, Barbara Windsor is currently appearing as Peggy Mitchell in Britain's favourite soap, EastEnders.

Cinderella also stars Natalie Imbruglia (Beth in Neighbours) as Cinderella and Mark Curry (Blue Peter and BBC Record Breakers) as Buttons. Mark Curry is no stranger to The Orchard Theatre having starred in Mother Goose with Gaby Roslin in 1991 and Michael Frayn's Noises Off at The Orchard in Spring 1995.

Cinderella is a popular fairy tale with all the elements that make a good Christmas pantomime, the rags to riches tale of the beautiful Cinderella, the loveable Buttons, The Ugly Sisters, the Wicked Stepmother and of course everyone's favourite, the Fairy Godmother. With plenty of humour, songs, audience participation and cries of "he's behind you", this will be a festive treat for the whole family to enjoy.

Tickets are now on sale from the Box Office on 01322 220000, priced £6 to £13.50.



WESTMOUNT ROAD – ACCIDENT REVIEW

Following an accident in Westmount Road earlier this year Greenwich Council undertook a safety review of the road.

Greenwich Council commissioned the London Accident Analysis Unit (LAAU) to carry out the safety audit.

The results of the audit were encouraging but recommended additional give way signs on side roads and additional road markings to the long island. The additional markings are proposed to encourage drivers on the downhill approach to the island to follow the bend in the road and not take a faster straighter line. It also recommends further monitoring of the section of Westmount Road between Earshall Road and Greenvale Road.

The report looked at the accident rate on the road both before and since traffic management schemes were introduced in March 1990. (Further measures were introduced in June 1992). During the period from 1987 to March 1995 (8 years 3 months) there were 71 accidents in which personal injuries were sustained. Prior to the traffic management scheme which involved the installation of a pelican crossing, pedestrian refuges and central hatching marks the accident rate was running at 1.03 per month. This was halved to 0.51 following the measures.

Councillor Chris Roberts, Chair of the Committee said "I will be recommending the Committee to agree to the measures proposed in order that they can be carried out in the current financial year. I would also like to take this opportunity of expressing my concern about the distress caused to the parents and friends of the young people killed in the tragic accident by the removal of the memorabilia placed around the tree."

ENVIRONMENTAL IMPROVEMENT WORKS IN POWIS STREET

Woolwich and Charlton Area Sub Committee agreed the first stage of works to improve Powis Street in Woolwich. The scheme, which is fully funded by money from the Single Regeneration Budget, is one of several projects aimed at improving the town centre.

The main objectives of the schemes are:

- to create a safer and more pedestrian friendly environment
- improve the visual quality of the Town Centre for the benefit of all users
- remove excessive street clutter
- provide better seating and high quality street furniture
- break-up the monotonous concrete paving and provide more

Councillor Bob Harris, Deputy Leader of Greenwich Council said "I'm very pleased to see the first signs of recovery in Woolwich.

It has come about because businesses have joined in partnership with the council and the Development Agency and shown their commitment to the Town Centre."

Woolwich Development Agency Managing Director, Frances Dolan, added: "The Council is looking forward to the future and to the redevelopment of Woolwich which will also see the development of the Woolwich Arsenal into a heritage centre and the re-birth of Woolwich as the main shopping centre in the

CYCLE ROUTES APPROVED

Greenwich Council's Planning and Development Committee have recently approved a network of strategic cycle routes for the Borough.

The routes will form part of the London Cycle Network which aims to provide safe, convenient and conspicuous routes for cyclists throughout the capital. Greenwich has worked closely with neighbouring Boroughs to ensure compatibility of routes for people wishing to cycle to work, school, shopping or for leisure.

When planning road improvements the needs of cyclists will be taken into account and cycle lanes on main roads, protected crossings, contra-flow cycle lanes, and good singing will be considered.

This network forms part of the London Strategic Cycle Network for which funding of £47m in total will be sought for the whole of London. It is anticipated that the first phase of the Greenwich Borough part of the London network will be implemented in February 1996.

EXTRA PARKING FOR WOOLWICH

Shoppers in Woolwich now have an extra 60 parking spaces following works to the car park in Powis Street.

The work has been carried out as part of Greenwich's investment in the future of Woolwich and to help satisfy the parking demands of visitors to the town centre.

The car park which previously had only 45 public spaces has now been resurfaced and marked out with an extra 59 car spaces and a bike bay. New lighting has been installed and patrols will be operating for the extra security of users and their vehicles.

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THE HARRIS REPORT

NEWTON HEADER CLINCHES POINT

CHARLTON 1 SUNDERLAND 1
SATURDAY 5th NOVEMBER
ENDSLEIGH LEAGUE DIV ONE

After a run of four games without defeat against strong opposition this match provided an even sterner test than previous weeks against arguably the best team in the league.

Sunderland have money to spend, a quality squad and an excellent manager in Peter Reid so it wasn't suprising when the away side got off to by far the better start.

Despite this it was Charlton who took the lead with 10 minutes gone. Shaun Newton headed his third goal of the season after a pin point cross from Mark Robson. The lead only lasted seven minutes though, Michael Gray scoring the deserved equaliser as a result of several deflections.

At this point the game seemed destined to produce more goals. Charlton keeper Mike Salmon was taken off and replaced by Mike Ammann, but this did not prevent the never ending flow of chances. Lee Bowyer's back pass was intercepted by David Kelly who fired wide from 15 yards and man of the match Shaun Newton also came close with a long range effort.

The second period saw a continuation of the fast tempo but a steady decrease in the amount of chances. Some attacking passing football from the Addicks earned applause but there was rarely a final product. In fact the away side had the last goalside attempt when a Rufus mistake gave Phil Gray the opportunity to hit a powerful shot over. Another good performance seeing Charlton continue their impressive run.

LONDON BRONCOS AT THE VALLEY

Charlton Athletic Football Club and the London Broncos Rugby League club are pleased to announce an agreement that the Broncos will play five Courage Centenary League matches at The Valley, with a view to playing all London's home matches in the 1996 Super League season at the ground commencing in the Spring.

Charlton Director Jonathan Fuller commented, "we are delighted to welcome the Broncos to The Valley. With professional rugby league moving to the summer, hosting the London side would be an ideal utilisation of our ground and facilities, which otherwise are only used twenty five times a year. Whilst there are obviously financial benefits in this arrangement, having two top professional sporting clubs operating from the ground will also raise the profile of The Valley and the area as a whole."

Mr. Fuller praised Greenwich Council for their support of the initiative which will see the top club side Wigan visit The Valley on 3 December. Details of the other fixtures will be announced shortly.

Current planning permission for the ground limits the number of non-association football matches which may be held each year, however, the Club is seeking an amendment to the deed of planning. Leader of Greenwich Council Len Duval commented, "we shall monitor the five matches this season with interest. this is a very exciting move from which the area can benefit greatly."

The new Super League is to be televised around the world providing great opportunities for promoting all those involved at The Valley.

London Broncos Chairman Barry Maranta commented, "I'm delighted with the welcome we have received from Charlton and with the facilities available at the Valley. I believe it will be an ideal location for the London Broncos and the super League with its excellent communication links, extensive car parking and local railway station.

The reaction from the football club and the Council has been first rate and I look forward to a successful relationship with both."

NFA MEETS ITS CRITICS

THE NATIONAL FEDERATION OF ANGLERS has always had it critics, though most of the time th organisation is considered to be a fault simply for applying the rule which have been voted for by th membership.

There is little which can b done about that, though nobod can be right or wrong all the time and it is always possible t improve things. That is why th NFA recently organised a informal meeting with three anglers who have been responsibl for criticism in the Press about th way various NFA competition have been run.

"We decided to hear what thes anglers - Peter Clapperton, Roge Mortimer and Mark Addy, - had t say, face to face, at a meeting a our Derbyshire HQ, "said NF vice president David Kent. "The are all closely involved with th running of leading teams takin part in our events and, howeve good we may think we are a running them we recognise th dangers of complacency.

Constructive criticism

The anglers were not afraid t explain their criticisms, whic were at all times constructive They gave the NFA their ideas o how to eliminate the advantage end peg draws in all tea competitions.

They discussed the problems team changes on match days, an the controversial issue of ban runners. The use of officia transport to and from section frequently the cause of dispute also got an airing.

Disciplinary measures unde the present rules, the closing match venues prior to Nationa Championships, date and venu rotation for nationals, team poo and the individual National a came in for lengthy consideration

"We think it was a ver productive meeting, "said M Kent. "The NFA officials got better insight into things form th anglers point of view, and we g some good ideas for the futur The anglers, for their par appreciated the opportunity participate, and to help to mak good events even better.

"I am sure we will stage simil meetings in the future, perha with different anglers".

VASE GLORY FOR THAMESMEAD

THAMESMEAD 1 ASHFORD (MIDDX) 0
SATURDAY 28TH OCTOBER
F.A. VASE

A new look 'Mead' overcame Combined Counties league Ashford at Bayliss Avenue today. In front of large away support Thamesmead progressed to the second stage of the Vase by a solitary goal which came early in an eventful second half.

After a quiet first period chances fell freely to both sides as the tie wore on. Thamesmead took the lead on 54 minutes through Rasheed Short who hammered into an open net from three yards after a well directed corner. 'Mead' had several chances to increase their lead and always looked like the eventual victors. Burns found himself clean through only to hit wide after rounding the keeper and Mccarthy hit the bar with a powerful close range shot to complete an action packed game.

DERES' UPDATE

Three creditable draws against Whitney, Sittingbourne and ICIS league Billericay have gone a long way to kick starting the Deres season. After a nightmare start in both league and cup the run of form couldn't have come at a better time.

Second from bottom in the Beazer Homes Southern league Erith have seen an ever increasing gap develop between themselves and the teams above. With no further interest in cup competition all energies will now be geared towards an unwanted relegation battle.

Erith and Belvedere have shown signs of improvement in recent weeks though, demonstrating an excellent battling spirit. The season is now too old for lacklustre performances so let's hope that Erith can continue their string of results and pick up some desperately needed points, if only to avoid the threat of relegation.

KENT COUNTY CRICKET CLUB

PRESIDENT FOR 1996
R.J. BAKER WHITE

Robin Baker White, who is aged 63 and lives at Street End Place, Street End, Canterbury and is currently High Sheriff of Kent, has been nominated as the next President of Kent County Cricket Club. Robin served on the General Committee of the Club from 1985 to 1990. He has been, over the years, a diligent worker for and generous benefactor to the Kent County Cricket Club by organising many benefit functions for Kent beneficiaries, by sponsoring players' cars and Kent match expenses, by serving on a number of Kent County Cricket Club Appeal Committees (organising many fund raising events).

He is President of Street End Cricket club whose ground he owns. He is a member of MCC, the Band of Brothers, the XL Club and the Cricket Society and serves on a wide range of Agricultural and local Kent and Canterbury Committees. Robin is a direct descendant on his father's side of William De Chair Baker, the first ever Secretary of the modern Kent County Cricket Club and the Beverley Cricket Club founded in 1835 by William De Chair Baker and John Gerard. Robin was educated at Blundells School, Devon, was commissioned in the 15th/19th Kings Royal Hussars during his National Service and currently manages the family farm and estate.

Don't be a dark horse

Every year there are over three thousand accidents on the roads involving horses – eight a day. these figures include several fatalities.

Many accidents could be avoided if car drivers would hold back, and only pass wide and slow – when the road is clear. However accidents often occur because motorists fail to see the horse and rider until too late.

Riders need to be aware of how invisible they can be. Wearing wax jackets with dark hat and jodhpurs, usually on a dark bay horse, they too often blend into the shadows.

BHS Executive Safety officer Lesley Billingham comments: "Riders should develop a responsible attitude towards road safety and realise that when on roads they become 'road users' like everyone else. We urge horse riders to adopt the lead of the police in the way that they dress by wearing fluorescent and reflective clothing. Visible attire should be worn as a matter of course, especially now that the darker days of winter are here.

The BHS message is simple but effective: **DON'T BE A DARK HORSE – BE SEEN TO BE SAFE**

The Bill versus London's Burning

Charity Football Match in aid of the British Red Cross
at
Bromley Town Football Club, Hayes Lane, Bromley BR2 9EF
Sunday 19th November 1995. Kick off 2.00pm
Matched Kicked-off by Katherine Rogers (Josie)

Celebrating British Red Cross 125th Birthday
Admission £2 for Adults. Children & OAPs £1

Tickets available from: The British Red Cross
St Pauls House, Edison Road, Bromley BR2 0EP
Tel: 0181-460 4020

A chance for you to meet the cast of the Bill and London's Burning.
Supported by: Thames Television and LWT

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Members Winter Warmer Offer!
Don't cool down this winter, warm up wth our special winter warmer sauna offer. Take a sauna for only £1.50 after any keep fit class during the same visit. (Offer ends 31.12.95)

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